

LibreOffice now available in Intel AppUp centre

The open source LibreOffice productivity suite is now available in the Intel AppUp centre, which is an online repository designed for Intel processor-based devices. "We welcome Intel to The Document Foundation and look forward to working with them," said Dr Gerald Pfeifer, senior director of product management, SUSE. "It's great to see Intel providing LibreOffice through an exciting new channel so that more and more users can experience LibreOffice on Windows — with access to our world-class support that can make organisations more productive while saving costs."



Adobe discontinues Flash Player for Linux

Adobe has announced plans to discontinue direct downloads of Flash Player for Linux. After the release of Flash Player 11.2 later this year, Linux users who want to view Flash content will only be able to do it through Google's Chrome browser.

Adobe announced in its roadmap document that Flash Player 11.2 would be the last native version for Linux. This release will feature mouse-lock support, right and middle mouse-click support, context menu disabling, support for more hardware accelerated video cards (from January 2008) in order to expand availability of hardware-accelerated content, new Throttle event API (dispatches an event when Flash Player throttles, pauses, or resumes content), and a multi-threaded video decoding pipeline on the desktop.

For Flash Player releases after 11.2, the Flash Player browser plug-in for Linux will only be available via the Pepper API under the Google Chrome browser distribution. Thereafter, it won't be available as a direct download from Adobe. Adobe will, however, continue to provide security updates to non-Pepper distributions of Flash Player 11.2 on Linux for five years from its release.



VALO-CD now available in English

VALO-CD has been distributing free and open source software for Finnish users since 2008. Now, its collection is available in English as well. VALO-CD is a project that distributes free and open source software. A single CD with selected best-in-class applications makes it easy for any user to enjoy the advantages of free software on Windows.

Now, in addition to the existing Finnish language edition, it is available in English too. This is the first official international version of VALO-CD. You can find out more about the CD and download it at www.valo-cd.net.

All VALO-CD programs run on the Windows operating system. Most of the applications have GNU/Linux support, which makes it easy for VALO-CD users to switch between operating systems with seamless workflow and flawless interoperability. The purpose of the project is to make free and open source software more widely known.

It is a collection of the best programs most desktop users would need.



Open source code quality as good as proprietary code quality

The 2011 Coverity Scan Open Source Integrity Report (Scan), a public-private sector research project, has reached the conclusion that open source code is as good in quality as that of proprietary software. The research project was started by Coverity and the US Department of Homeland Security in 2006. Researchers tested over 300 million lines of proprietary software code and over 37 million lines of open source software code to reach the conclusion.

The report analysed code from 45 of the most active Scan open source projects. It is worth mentioning here that an average open source project in Scan has 832,000 lines of code. The number of defects per thousand lines of code or the average defect density in the open source projects in Scan was 0.45. On the other hand, over 300 million lines of code from around 41 proprietary codebases were taken into account. An average codebase under analysis had 7.5 million lines of code. The average defect density in this case was found to be 0.64.

As per the average defect density of Coverity, both open source code quality and proprietary code quality proved to be better than the average for the software industry. The average of software industry estimates the defect density to be 1.0.

The researchers found that open source projects, including Linux 2.6, PHP 5.3, and PostgreSQL 9.1, had the superior code quality. They emphasised that these codes can be treated as industry benchmarks that had achieved defect densities of 0.62, 0.20 and 0.21, respectively.